

Timeline of the 2026 Iran war

This **timeline of the 2026 Iran war** covers the period since 28 February 2026, when it began, and is ongoing.

27 February

- 20:38 UTC – President Donald Trump of the United States gives the order to proceed with Operation Epic Fury.^{[1][2][3]}

28 February

Israeli–US strikes

- 06:35 UTC: CENTCOM announces that it "and partner forces" have begun airstrikes against Iran.^[4] US warships launch Tomahawk missiles, while the US Army used HIMARS launchers.^[5] Undisclosed long-range standoff weapons were also used.^[5] The US military stated that it used B-2 stealth bombers, as well as B-1 Lancers and B-52 Stratofortresses, to strike fortified ballistic missile facilities inside Iran.^[6]
- ~06:45 UTC – The Israeli Air Force begins an unprecedented wave of decapitation strikes.^[7] Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and several high officials (attending three meetings at his residential compound) are killed, as were members of his family. The United States Navy, United States Air Force and United States Marine Corps focus primarily on command-and-control infrastructure, missiles, UAV sites, radar installations, etc.^[8]
- Defence Minister Israel Katz confirms an Israeli attack.^{[9][10][11]}
- Channel 12, citing unnamed Israeli sources, said Israel assessed that there were "growing indications" that Khamenei was likely killed in the strikes, or that he was "hurt at the very least".^[12]
- The Fars News Agency and CNN reported more explosions across other cities in Iran, including Qom, Kermanshah, Isfahan, and Karaj.^{[13][14]} In Tehran, missile strikes were reported to have occurred on University Street, in the Jomhuri area, and in the northern Seyed Khandan area.^[15]
- 07:15 UTC:^[16] The Shajareh Tayyebah girls' elementary school in Minab, Iran, is struck by a missile. Iranian media reports 180 killed.^{[17][18][19]}
- Low-cost one-way attack drones (reverse-engineered Iranian Shahed 136 drone) of Task Force Scorpion Strike are used for the first time in combat.^[20] The attacks also used about 200 Israeli fighter jets, in the largest combat sortie in Israel's history,^[21] and the newly developed Black Sparrow air-launched ballistic missile, fired from F-15s.^[22]
- Israel warns Iranian civilians residing near military industries and infrastructure to evacuate immediately, stating "Your presence in these areas puts your life at risk." according to Iran International.^[23]



USS Frank E. Petersen Jr. fires a Tomahawk missile during Operation Epic Fury on 28 February 2026.

- A spokesperson for the Iraqi Popular Mobilization Forces says that two of its fighters had been killed while three more had been injured during strikes in Jurf al-Sakhar, south of Baghdad.^[24]
- A sports hall in Lamerd is bombed during a girls' practice, killing at least 18 civilians, according to Iranian state media.^[25]
- A spokesperson for the Iraqi Popular Mobilization Forces says that two of its fighters had been killed while three more had been injured during strikes in Jurf al-Sakhar, south of Baghdad.
- The IRGC reports that the port city of Bushehr had also been struck; however, it was unclear whether the nuclear reactor had sustained any damage.^[23] Rafael Mariano Grossi, the U.N. nuclear watchdog chief stated that no evidence has been found that nuclear facilities^[26] have been hit from these attacks.^[27]



Damaged residential area in Lamerd, southwest Iran, after a reported missile attack targeting local infrastructure

Iranian strikes

- 09:05 UTC: In retaliation to the American and Israeli strikes, Iran launches ballistic missiles towards Israel and several Gulf states.^{[28][29][4]}
- 09:26 UTC: A missile strikes the USN Fifth Fleet service center in Bahrain.^[4]
- 10:15 UTC: Missile strikes are confirmed in Israel.^[4]
- 12:30 UTC: The IDF estimates that about 170 ballistic missiles have been launched by Iran.^[30]
- Bahrain activates air-raid sirens to warn of an Iranian attack on US military bases within the nation, with Arabic media saying explosions and smoke were seen in the capital, Manama.^{[31][32]} Bahrain later confirmed a missile strike had targeted the US Fifth Fleet headquarters.^[33]
- Explosions are reported at Kuwait International Airport and Abu Dhabi in the United Arab Emirates.^{[34][35]} There were missile and drone attacks on Kuwait.^[36]
- The IRGC said that Iran had targeted four US bases in the Middle East: Al Udeid Air Base in Qatar; Ali Al Salem Air Base in Kuwait (which also hosted Italian soldiers);^[37] Al Dhafra Air Base in the UAE; and the US Navy Fifth Fleet headquarters in Bahrain.^[38]
- Saudi Arabia confirms that there had been Iranian attacks on Riyadh and Eastern Province.^[39] It claimed to have successfully intercepted Iranian attacks aimed at those areas and said that the Kingdom will "take all necessary measures" to defend itself, "including the option of responding to aggression".^[40]
- The UAE states that it had successfully intercepted a number of Iranian missiles and that one Asian national had been killed by interceptor debris which had fallen on a residential area.^{[41][42]}
- Qatar says that it had intercepted at least two waves of missile attacks, stating that no casualties or property damage had been reported.^[43]
- In the Kurdistan Region of Iraq, Iranian aerial attacks target infrastructure hosting US military and civilian personnel, including Erbil International Airport and the US Consulate General in Erbil; according to local media reports, most missiles and drones were intercepted.^[44]
- Strikes were reported in Haifa and Tel Aviv.^[45]
- A strike on a residential area in Tel Aviv killed a civilian woman in her forties and injured 27 others.^[46] Jordan said that its armed forces had shot down two Iranian ballistic missiles targeting



The first four US soldiers killed during the war

its territory^{[47][48]} and that it had handled 54 reports of falling debris that caused material damage but no casualties.^[49]

- Residential areas of Dubai in the proximity of the Burj Khalifa, Dubai Marina and the Dubai Palm were hit by strikes, setting the Fairmont The Palm hotel on fire^[50] and causing four injuries; a residential building on the outskirts of Doha was also hit.^{[51][43][52][53]} Local sources said Iran used Shahed drones, which are among the weapons most used by Iran and its proxies, including Hamas and Hezbollah.^[54] The UAE said that it had intercepted a "new wave" of Iranian missiles and that "fragments from the interceptions" had fallen in Abu Dhabi and Dubai, causing damage to Burj Al Arab.^{[55][56]} Strikes on Kuwait International Airport caused several undefined injuries.^[50] In Bahrain, during the evening a tower in a residential area was reported to be hit by an Iranian drone.

Other developments

- At 2:30 AM EST, Trump posted a video to Truth Social announcing military intervention in Iran.^[57]
- Israel also conducted coordinated cyberattacks on Iranian infrastructure, media, and phone apps with messages calling on Iranians to rise up against their government.^[58] The popular BadeSaba Calendar prayer app, with over 5 million downloads, was compromised in the attack, being hacked early that morning to broadcast push notifications in Persian urging military personnel and citizens to defect, lay down weapons, and join opposition forces with messages such as "Help has arrived" and "It's time for reckoning."^{[59][60][61]}
- Israel declares a state of emergency, citing expectation of an Iranian attack.^[62] Sirens blared in Israel as the government warned its citizens to remain in protected areas.^[63] The Israeli Ministry of Health moved its hospital operations underground.^[64]
- According to Iran International, Israel warns Iranian civilians residing near military industries and infrastructure to evacuate immediately, stating "Your presence in these areas puts your life at risk."^[23]
- Israel called up 20,000 reservists in addition to the 50,000 already on duty.^[65]
- American officials confirm that the strikes were coordinated with the US.^[66]
- After the missile and drone attacks on Kuwait, its foreign ministry summoned Mohammad Toutounchi, Iran's ambassador in Kuwait.^[36]



Rescuers and residents searching through the rubble of the Minab girls' elementary school, destroyed by the United States

1 March

U.S.-Israeli attacks in Iran

- Israel executed another wave of strikes against Iranian targets as part of its ongoing campaign,^[67] aiming at the centre of Tehran.^[68] The US Air Force launched B-2 bombers to strike Iranian ballistic missile facilities.^{[69][70]} CENTCOM declared that it was instructed to "dismantle the Iranian regime's security apparatus."^[71]
- Israel and the United States launched strikes against targets in Tehran, Sanandaj, and military and strategic locations including command centers and missile sites.^{[72][73][74]}
- The Israel Defense Forces says that it bombed an F-4 and an F-5 fighter jet preparing to take off from a runway,^[75] and the HQ-9B system around Tehran is inactivated.^[76]

- The USAF flies B-2 Bombers and to attack hardened ballistic missile facilities with 2,000 pound bombs. USN F/A-18s and USMC F-35s, aided by Tomahawk missiles were also employed along with Lucas drones.^{[69][70]} CENTCOM declared that it was instructed to "dismantle the Iranian regime's security apparatus."^[71]
- The Tehran Revolutionary Court is bombed and destroyed.^[77] Explosions are also reported near the Azadi Stadium, Azadi Square, and Milad Tower.^[78]
- The Iranian Red Crescent Society reports explosions near hospitals in Tehran, as well as near its Peace Building.^[78]
- The IDF declares it had levelled the "General Staff of the Internal Security forces", along with the Thar-Allah Headquarters.^[79]
- Mohammad Baseri, an official in the ministry of intelligence, and Gholamreza Rezaian, the head of the intelligence department of FARAJA police, are both killed in strikes on Iran.^[78]
- At least 5 people are killed by strikes on residential areas in the Absardar region.^[80]

Iranian attacks

Iran launches retaliatory missile and drone strikes against Israel, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain, Jordan, and Saudi Arabia.^{[81][82][83]}

- Iran claims to have shot down an American MQ-9 Reaper drone.^[84]
- Missiles from Iran are fired at Fifth Fleet headquarters in Bahrain.^{[85][82][83]}
- Witnesses see smoke from missile intercepts over Dubai and dark plumes rising from the Port of Jebel Ali, United Arab Emirates.^[67]
- An explosion occurs near the Erbil Airport after an attack by Iraqi militia drones.^[78]
- During drone operations in the Strait of Hormuz, the port of Duqm in Oman is reportedly hit by two drones, injuring one expatriate worker.^[86]
- Oman's Maritime Security Centre confirms that an oil tanker which was Palau-flagged, named *Skylight*, had been targeted 5 nautical miles (9.3 km) north of the port of Khasab, causing four injuries amongst the Indian-Iranian crew present on the vessel.^[87]
- The Marshall Islands-flagged tanker *MKD VYOM* is damaged after being struck off the coast of Oman, killing one crew member.^{[88][89]}
- As a result of the conflict and higher risk to ships, 150 freight ships, including many oil tankers, are stalled behind the strait.^[90]
- Riyadh is again hit by direct strikes.^[91]
- An Iranian missile breaches Israeli defences and hits a synagogue in Beit Shemesh, killing nine people, leaving 11 missing and injuring 51 others.^{[24][92]}
- An Iranian drone hits the Crowne Plaza Hotel in Manama, Bahrain, causing a fire.^{[93][94]}
- In Abu Dhabi a drone is intercepted near the Etihad Towers complex, near the Israeli embassy, and upon being intercepted its debris damaged the towers and caused minor injuries to a woman and her child.^[95]
- Iranian attacks kill one person and injure 32 in Kuwait.^[96]
- The IRGC claims that it struck USS Abraham Lincoln with four missiles,^[97] which is later denied by a US official.^[24]
- The French naval base Camp de la Paix in Abu Dhabi is reportedly struck by an Iranian missile or drone.^[98]
- Two Iranian drones target a warehouse at Al-Salam Naval Base in Abu Dhabi, causing a fire in two containers storing general materials.^[99]
- A Saudi oil refinery is closed after being targeted by Iranian drones. An analyst stated this "marks a significant escalation".^[100]

- UK military officials say an RAF Typhoon shot down an Iranian drone bound for Qatari airspace.^[101]
- Towards the end of the day, an Iranian ballistic missile hits an area of Jerusalem, causing property damage in the surrounding road, damaging a civilian vehicle and wounding six people.^[102]
- Debris from an unidentified missile falls in Ain Tarma, Syria, causing some damage and injuries.^{[103][104]}

Mediterranean theater

- UK Defence Secretary John Healey says that Iran had fired two missiles towards British bases on Cyprus, but adds that he did not believe they were under attack.^{[105][106]} Defence Minister of Cyprus Vasilis Palmas denies that missiles were launched at Cyprus, and Prime Minister Keir Starmer affirms this.^[107]

Other developments

- Iran's top security official, Ali Larijani, announces a temporary leadership council after the death of Ali Khamenei.^[67] He warns "secessionist groups" of severe consequences if they take action.^[67]
- Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman of Saudi Arabia authorized military force against further Iranian incursions.^[108]
- To avert further Iranian strikes, the E3 (the UK, France, and Germany) resolve to back, if needed, "proportionate military defensive measures" against drones and ballistic missiles.^[109] British Prime Minister Keir Starmer announces approval of US use of British bases for "defensive" strikes on Iran.^[110]
- The EU announced the expansion of Operation Aspides in response to increased requests for protection from commercial vessels.^[111]

Timestamped events (UTC)

- About 22:00 UTC: a series of loud blasts were recorded in Doha,^[112] and continued to be heard hours later.^[113]
- About 02:30 UTC: An Amazon Web Services data center within the UAE is "impacted by objects that struck" it, resulting in "sparks and fire". Reuters reported that this resulted in a complete power cut and shutdown of the centre with the involvement of local fire department crews, leading to a temporary connectivity outage of the availability zone impacted.^[114]
- About 15:30 UTC: Saudi Arabia claims that it had shot down missiles fired at Prince Sultan Airbase and King Khalid International Airport.^[115]
- About 00:20 UTC: the Royal Air Force station at Akrotiri, Cyprus, is targeted by a suspected drone strike, setting off air raid sirens across Akrotiri and Dhekelia.^[116] Five drones are reportedly intercepted although one managed to hit the airfield, causing minor damage.^{[117][118]} The British military automated alert system stated that there was an "ongoing security threat",^[119] and the UK Ministry of Defence claimed that "the base has responded" to the attack. This was later confirmed by Cypriot authorities.^[120] The drones were launched before the UK allowed the US to use its military bases for operations against Iran.^[121]

2 March

U.S.-Israeli attacks in Iran

- The Iranian Red Crescent reports 555 killed.^[122]
- Khamenei's wife, Mansoureh Khojasteh Bagherzadeh, reportedly died from her injuries on 2 March.^[123]
- Israel launches strikes on targets in Tehran and Sanandaj, as well as hitting military and strategic locations including command centers and missile sites.^[72]
- Satellite images taken by Vantor on 1 and 2 March were made public, which showed that Iran's Natanz Nuclear Facility in Isfahan, Iran, had sustained damage.^{[124][125]} Subsequently, the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) confirmed that satellite imagery showed that entrance buildings at Natanz were damaged, but no radiological consequence was expected and no additional impact had been detected at the fuel enrichment plant itself.^[126]
- The Khatam-al-Anbia and Gandhi hospitals in Tehran are hit by strikes, as reported by Iran and verified by BBC Verify.^[127]
- The USAF hits military aircraft and drone launchers, including multiple F-14 Tomcats at airbases across Iran.^[73]
- The IDF says that it hit dozens of command sites and other targets at night in Tehran, including ten belonging to the Ministry of Intelligence and one belonging to the Quds Force.^[74]
- Later attacks hit the Islamic Republic of Iran Broadcasting headquarters in Evin, Tehran.^[128]
- According to Al Arabiya Israeli special forces and Mossad operatives carried out a ground operation inside Iran; no details were included.^[129]



Damage to residential buildings in Sanandaj, Iranian Kurdistan, after a military strike

Iranian attacks

Iran launches retaliatory strikes. CNN reports explosions in major cities of the Gulf region. Explosions are reported in Dubai, Abu Dhabi, and Doha.^[130]

- Smoke rises from the US embassy in Kuwait^[131] which is subsequently closed indefinitely.^[132]
- Two drones targeted the US Victory Base near Baghdad International Airport, one of which reportedly struck the base.^[133] There were reports of explosions in Erbil, Kurdistan Region, Iraq.^[134] A pro-Iran group called the "Guardians of the Blood Brigade" stated they were behind these two attacks, and claimed they were in retaliation for Khamenei's assassination.^[135]
- An Iranian strike targets Mina Salman port in Bahrain causing a fire.^[136]
- Falling debris from an intercepted missile on a "foreign ship" in Salman industrial zone resulted in the death of a worker and serious injuries to two others.^[137]
- A refining facility is damaged in Aramco's Ras Tanura in Saudi Arabia, causing a contained fire. It was initially believed to be caused by a drone attack, but Saudi officials stated it was debris from an intercepted Iranian missile,^{[138][139]} and Iran denied it had targeting the facility.^[140]
- According to state run Kuwait News Agency, an oil refinery is hit by shrapnel.^[130]
- In Bahrain, the Ministry of Interior states that sirens had sounded across the country.^[130]

- UAE officials claim to have downed 148 Iranian drones, nine ballistic missiles, and half a dozen cruise missiles.^[141]
- All staff members at the US-Jordanian embassy are evacuated "due to a threat".^[142]
- In Cyprus, Paphos International Airport is evacuated upon the detection of a foreign unidentified object in the sky,^[143] and at the same time sirens sound once again at Akrotiri base upon the detection of a possible threat.^[144] Later on the Cypriot government confirmed that the objects were two drones which were intercepted without causing any damages.^[145] After the incident, Greece announced that they would deploy frigates and F-16s to defend Cyprus from any further strikes by Iran.^[146] Later in the day IRGC general Sardar Jabbari comments that there was a US presence on the island of Cyprus and that Iran plans to strike the island "with such intensity that the Americans will be forced to leave".^{[147][148]}
- Iran carries out attacks targeting energy infrastructure in Qatar. Iranian drones struck Qatar's liquefied natural gas (LNG) facilities, halting production. In addition, missiles and drones were launched at sites in Qatar, including the Al Udeid Air Base and industrial facilities. Qatari forces said they intercepted many of these.^{[149][150]} US-flagged tanker *Stena Imperative* was hit by projectiles off Bahrain, causing a fire that was extinguished.^[151]
- The IRGC claimed a drone strike on the Honduras-flagged tanker *Athe Nova* in the Strait of Hormuz.^[152]
- 19 people are injured after an Iranian missile hit a neighborhood in Beersheba, Israel.^[153]
- The Islamic Resistance in Iraq claims responsibility for over 23 drone strikes on US assets in Erbil.^[154]
- The U.S. Central Command announces the death of six U.S. service members killed in action.^[142]

Lebanon theater

- Projectiles being launched from within Lebanon toward its territory in the early hours of 2 March, setting off sirens across Haifa and the Upper Galilee.^{[155][156]} The IDF says that it intercepted a rocket from Hezbollah, while others hit open areas.^[157] Israeli intel believes the attack was the result of an order from Tehran, and the IDF spokesperson issued an emergency statement stating that the attack is to be considered "an official declaration of war by Hezbollah", vowing to "neutralize" the threat.^[158] Hezbollah confirmed its responsibility, saying that it attacked an IDF base in Haifa in response to Khamenei's killing.^[159]
- In response to Hezbollah's attacks, the IDF proceeds with a series of strategic bombings on Beirut and the Begaa Valley.^[158] Strikes also hit southern Lebanon.^[160] Israel warns Lebanese people who fled from their homes not to return, and multiple people said they do not know how they will access food or water after the sun comes down.^[135] The IDF later announced that it struck more than 70 targets in Dahieh and southern Lebanon.^[161] The IDF strikes three southern Lebanese towns, including Haris, Nabatieh al-Fawqa, and Mayfadoun, and later issued an evacuation order in 50 adjacent communities.^{[133][162]} The IDF says it killed the head of Hezbollah's intelligence headquarters Hussein Makled in the strikes.^{[163][164]} In the night, it reported the killing of Abu Hamza Rami, the Palestinian Islamic Jihad commander in Lebanon, in Beirut.^[165]

Other developments

- Qatar shoots down two Iranian Su-24 bombers, making it the first nation to shoot down manned Iranian aircraft in the conflict.^[166]
- Three US F-15 fighters crash in Kuwait. Iran claims to have shot them down,^[167] while later CentCom attributed it to friendly fire by Kuwait.^[131]

- Trump has not ruled out boots on the ground in Iran.^{[168][169][170]}
- A senior Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps official who is an advisor to the IRGC commander says he would set on fire any ship sailing through the Strait of Hormuz, adding that no oil will leave the area.^[171]
- Khamenei's wife Mansoureh Khojasteh Bagherzadeh is confirmed to have also died of injuries sustained in the strike.^[172]

3 March

The war dramatically expands; nine countries are now involved.^[173]

U.S.-Israeli attacks in Iran

- According to CENTCOM commander Admiral Brad Cooper, the United States "destroyed 17 Iranian ships, including the most operational Iranian submarine that now has a hole in its side."^[174]
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- Israel continues to pursue strikes and operations in Lebanon and Iran in the early hours of the day.^[175]
- Also in the early hours of the day, sirens all over Bahrain started to be activated as the government called for residents to stay safe.^[130]
- The Iranian Red Crescent Society raises the number killed to 787.^[176]
- Isfahan and Kermanshah and Shiraz and IEI^[177] are bombed, along with other cities.^[178]
- IRIB Tehran HQ was bombed second day in row and switched to Telewebion IP internet streaming TV. Old Mirdamad St., the historic imperial Senate of Iran and the current seat of the Assembly of Experts is bombed.^{[179][180][181]}
- The IDF says that it destroyed a covert nuclear site in Iran.^[182]
- The U.S. sinks missile corvette IRIS Shahid Soleimani, the lead ship of an Iranian class with the same name.^[183]
- The U.S sinks the submarine IRIS Fateh, Iran's only operational Fateh-class submarine.^[184] It is the first submarine to be sunk during a conflict since the Falklands War.
- Israel says it killed one of the commanders of the IRGC.^[185]
- The IDF announced that it had destroyed the Supreme National Security Council (SNSC) headquarters, along with command-and-control infrastructure and the president's office, noting that it targeted "the regime's most central and significant headquarters".^[186]
- Golestan Palace, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, was hit by debris from an Israeli-US airstrike, causing some damage^[187] including to the Brilliant Hall and the Marble Throne. The Ministry of Cultural Heritage, Tourism and Handicrafts officially asked UNESCO to evaluate the situation, and UNESCO issued a statement, noting that damaging UNESCO property is against international laws.^[188]
- The IDF says that it killed Daoud Alizadeh, the commander of the Quds Force's Lebanon branch, in Tehran.^[189]
- US–Israeli airstrikes level the Expediency Discernment Council building in Tehran.^[190]
- The IDF says it hit an alleged secret nuclear weapons development facility in Tehran that it identified as Min Zadaï, and had destroyed 300 Iranian missile launchers since the war began.^[182]
- In southern Iran, Bushehr Airport is targeted in a precision strike that resulted in the total destruction of an Iran Air Airbus A319 (EP-IEP) parked on the tarmac. The Mehr News Agency reported significant structural damage to the airport terminal.^{[191][192]} The proximity of the strikes

to the Bushehr Nuclear Power Plant (About 12 km (7.5 mi) away) prompted the Russian agency Rosatom to suspend construction on new units and evacuate non-essential staff due to a loss of communication with Iranian officials.^[193]

- Iranian media reported that the Assembly of Experts' office in Qom had been bombed, reportedly during a session convened for electoral purposes.

Iranian attacks

- Iran continued retaliating with strikes on Israel and the Gulf states.^{[194][195][196]}
- Iran launches massive drone strikes against Irbil, Iraq.^[197]
- Bahrain reports 74 successfully intercepted missiles and 92 drones since 28 February.^[198]
- The Israeli cities of Bnei Brak and Rosh HaAyin saw Iranian strikes causing a total of seven injuries amongst civilians.^[199] Hezbollah reported to have struck down an Israeli drone in Nabatieh.^[200]
- The UAE detects numerous missiles heading from Iran towards the UAE at around 3:30 a.m. local time (23:30 GMT).^[194]
- The US embassy in Riyadh is struck by two Iranian drones, causing a fire and prompting its closure.^{[201][202][195]}
- Israeli Police report that one person was injured after Iranian shrapnel fell in Tel Aviv.^[196]
- Amazon Web Services are targeted across the Gulf states causing significant damages in their facilities located in the UAE and Bahrain.^[171]
- There is an attack on Hamad International Airport which is stopped by Qatari forces.^[203]
- An Iranian attack on the UAE's Fujairah Oil Industry Zone causes debris to fall and start a fire.^[204]
- It is reported that the CIA headquarters in Riyadh was hit by a drone and later in the night the kingdom downed nine drones as soon as they entered Saudi airspace.^{[205][206]}
- The US Consulate in Al Seef, Dubai is struck by multiple drones, resulting in a fire.^[207]
- The Islamic Resistance in Iraq claimed responsibility for explosions in Erbil.^[208]

Lebanon theater

- Israel's Defense Minister authorizes a ground invasion of Lebanon, to seize strategic positions.^{[209][210]}
- Israel says it detained a dozen Hezbollah members after a rocket strike on Israel.^[211]
- World Health Organization Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus states that three paramedics were killed and six injured while working to help affected people in southern Lebanon.^[212]
- Hezbollah also launched drones and missiles at a trio of Israeli bases.^{[213][214]}

Other developments

- Iran bans food exports.^[215]
- The Iranian military orders people to uninstall and disable foreign social media apps on their phones due to "Mossad presence". The regime reportedly plans to cut SMS service and internal phone land lines as well.^{[216][217]}
- GCC Gulf Shield units are deployed to Bahrain according to Tasnim to quell Shia protests.^[218]
- State media reports that Ali Khamenei's son and possible heir Mojtaba Khamenei "miraculously survived missile strike" that ended his father's life.^[219]

- Iran announces that their IRGC troops were setting up checkpoints in cities nationwide.^[220]
- State media announced that Iran has stocked one month of wheat flour and essential food products.^[221]
- Iran has been 84 hours without internet connectivity.^{[222][223]}
- Iran International reports that Khamenei's son, Mojtaba Khamenei is elected as the Supreme Leader of Iran.^[224]
- U.S. announces intent to escort oil tankers through the Strait of Hormuz.^[225]
- Western diplomats and other sources told *The Jerusalem Post* that Qatar had struck Iran after Iranian attempts to directly strike Doha's airport and Qatar shooting down 2 Iranian Su-24 bombers.^[226] Channel 12 also reported Qatari strikes.^[227] Qatari Foreign Ministry spokesperson Majed al-Ansari vigorously denied the accusation that Qatar had joined the "campaign targeting Iran".^[228]

4 March

U.S.-Israeli attacks in Iran

- US Secretary of State Marco Rubio announces that the US-Israeli attacks in Iran are going to increase in their intensity.^[229]
- The joint strike targeted Azadi square in Tehran as well as military facilities, and the metro station.^[230] According to CENTCOM, the US military destroyed 19 Iranian ships, 1 submarine, and nearly 2,000 targets.^{[231][23]} After Iran's statement about firing on ships passing through the Strait of Hormuz, Trump said the US will provide military escort to commercial, cargo, and tanker ships if needed.^[232] The insurance industry expressed scepticism about the short-term feasibility of the measure.^[233]
- Israeli strikes hit the Basij headquarters, as well as missile launch pads, defense systems and the supply and logistics directorate affiliated with the regime's ground forces.^[234]
- IAF strikes Iranian military complex in eastern Tehran.^{[235][236]}
- The IDF announced that an F-35I "Adir" shot down a Russian-made Iranian Yak-130 fighter jet over Tehran, marking the first time in history a stealth fighter has shot down a manned fighter jet in combat. It was also the first time the Israeli Air Force shot down an aircraft since 1985.^{[237][238][239]}
- A U.S. submarine sinks Iranian warship IRIS Dena off the coast of Galle, Sri Lanka, killing 87 of its crewmen. The Iranian frigate was returning from International Fleet Review 2026, which was held in Visakhapatnam, India. 32 of its crewmen were rescued by the Sri Lankan navy.^{[240][241][242]}
- After few hours, US secretary of defense Pete Hegseth confirmed that the US Navy had launched an attack on IRIS Dena.^{[243][244]}
- 13:15 UTC Iranian warship sunk by U.S.-Israeli airstrike in the port of Bandar Abbas. The warship was a Soleimani Class Corvette. It was the second Iranian warship sunk that day.^{[245][246]}
- The U.S. has launched multiple strikes on PMF forces in Iraq throughout the day ^[247]
- 16:15 UTC Israel announced it had completed a major large scale airstrikes on a major military outpost housing soldiers from all branches of Iran's security apparatus.^[248]



Damaged buildings in Tehran after US-Israeli strikes

Iranian attacks

- A drone was downed in the proximity of Baghdad International Airport, whilst another wave of drones and missiles was intercepted in Erbil.^[249]
- IRGCN NEDSA Navy stated they blew up 10 commercial vessel & ships who attempted to travel through the Strait of Hormuz, one other vessel hit by bomb near Port Muscat city.^{[250][251]}
- IRGC Aerospace Force launch and attack the Port of Fujairah,^[252] Dubai, UAE with ballistic missile.^[253] Drones attack Sulaymaniyah, Iraqi Kurdistan.^[254]
- IRGC Ground Forces attack Kuwait and Erbil with large amount of drones.^[255] An 11-year-old girl was killed in Kuwait after being hit by shrapnel.^{[256][257]}
- At 11:45 UTC NATO air defences shoot down an Iranian missile over Hatay.^{[258][259][260]}
- 13:45 UTC Bahrain was attacked by Iranian missiles.^[261]
- The Al Udeid Air Base, which has been described as "the largest American base in the Middle East" is hit with no casualties, reported the Qatari Ministry of Defense.^[262]
- Aramco's Ras Tanura oil refining facility in Saudi Arabia is hit by a projectile.^[263]
- The pro-Iran militia Saraya Awliya al-Dam claim that they struck a "vital US asset" in Jordan, but this has not been confirmed either by an independent news outlet or CENTCOM.^[264]

Lebanon theater

- 10:00 UTC Syrian forces block the Syrian - Lebanese border, claiming to do so to block Hezbollah from crossing the border and smuggling weapons in and out of Lebanon.^{[265][266]}
- 11:55 to 12:35 UTC Multiple rockets, missiles, and drones launched towards Israel from Lebanon to the north and Iran from the east.^[267]
- 12:35 UTC Israel launches retaliatory airstrikes at Hezbollah targets in southern Lebanon.^[268]
- Israeli ground forces move into Lebanon due to continuous Hezbollah attacks aimed at Israeli civilians across the border. This lead to the first land based clashes of the war.^{[269][270][271][272]}
- Hezbollah claimed that it clashed with Israeli forces attempting to advance in Khiam, as well as launching rocket barrages at a concentration of troops in Kiryat Shmona.^[273]
- Hezbollah claims that it struck an Israeli tank in the town of Houla, Lebanon.^[274] Israel later said that two soldiers were injured by anti-tank fire in southern Lebanon.^[275]

Events in the Gulf States

- QatarEnergy declared force majeure on gas exports and shut down gas liquefaction.^[276]

Mediterranean theater

- Greek F-16 fighters downed multiple Iranian Shahed drones near Cyprus.^[277] Larnaca International Airport is temporarily closed in response.^{[278][279]} Reports suggested a closure of Cypriot airspace, but it was later dismissed as false by the Cypriot government.^[280]
- A ballistic missile is intercepted by NATO forces in Turkey in Dörtyol, Hatay Province, with a statement after interception stating that Turkey reserved the right to defend its territory and that the ordnance had fallen in its territory.^[281] No casualties were reported by the statement. A senior U.S. military official said that it had been shot down by an SM-3 interceptor launched from USS Oscar Austin.^[282] An anonymous Turkish official stated that the missile was directed towards "Greek Cyprus".^[283]

- Non-essential American workers in Cyprus are asked to evacuate the country due to the risks of a possible Iranian incursion in the future.^[284] After, the US State Department stated to avoid travelling to Cyprus given the current crisis.^[285]
- In an emergency meeting in Rome, Giorgia Meloni and other Italian officials consider sending reinforcement to Cyprus after the deployment by other European nations (Greece, France, Germany and the United Kingdom), specifically considering the deployment of the destroyer Caio Duilio as a possibility (with capability up to 350 kilometers).^[286]

Other developments

- Minister of Intelligence denied engaging in cease fire and peace talks negotiations according to New York Times.^[287]
- Iranian regime denied that deployed conscripted soldiers to Qeshm.^[288]
- IRGC telegram channel post name of Mojtaba Khamenei as regime experts Assembly appointed successor supreme leader.^[289]
- Iraq's national power grid goes down for unknown reasons.^[290]
- According to an unnamed official from the Coalition of Political Forces of Iranian Kurdistan, Iraqi-based Kurdish armed groups consisting of thousands of the Kurdistan Free Life Party (PJAK) troops had begun a military offensive into Iranian territory, with operations beginning earlier on 2 March.^[291] American and Israeli officials reportedly confirmed the events.^[292] However, an unnamed PJAK official denied the claims of an ongoing offensive and cross-border troop movements, as did Aziz Ahmed, deputy chief of staff to Kurdistan Region's prime minister Masrour Barzani.^[293]
- Qatar arrests ten individuals for operating as a cell of the IRGC in Qatari territory, collecting data on military infrastructure, with some trained to use drones.^[294]

5 March

U.S-Israeli attacks in Iran

- Iran's largest sports complex, the 12,000-seat indoor arena at Tehran's Azadi Stadium, was destroyed by an American-Israeli strike.^{[295][296]}
- Two Basij student leaders who were alleged to have been involved in the suppression of protests were killed in Israeli airstrikes.^[297]

Iranian retaliation and Hezbollah strikes

- Saudi Arabia reported that in the early hours of the day they had intercepted over three cruise missiles outside the city of Al-Kharj.^[298]
- Iran said it targeted Kurdish groups in Iraq and warned separatists amid the expanding conflict. Early on 5 March, Iran launched another round of missiles at Israel, setting off air-raid alerts in areas including Tel Aviv, though no casualties were immediately reported. According to The Guardian, Iran targeted a US oil tanker in the Persian Gulf.^[299] In response, Israel launched a widespread wave of attacks in Tehran.^[299]
- Iranian drones entered Azerbaijani airspace. One drone hit the terminal of the Nakhchivan International Airport and another fell near a school in the village of Shakarabad. This is the first Iranian attack on Azerbaijan in this conflict.^[300]
- Suspected debris from an intercepted Iranian missile landed in Petah Tikva, causing a fire.^[301]

- Azerbaijan says that two drones from Iran struck Azerbaijan's Nakhchivan exclave.^[302] One drone struck the terminal building of Nakhchivan International Airport, while another landed near a school building in the village of Şəkərabad, according to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, damaging the airport and injuring two civilians.^[303] Azerbaijan summoned their Iranian ambassador,^[304] withdrew their diplomats from Iran,^[305] and promised a military response.^[306] Iran's foreign minister Abbas Araghchi denied that Iran had attacked Azerbaijan, and suggested that it was an Israeli false flag attack.^[307] Azer News reported that a Telegram channel affiliated with the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, "Sepah Pasdaran News Channel", claimed responsibility for the attack in Nakhchivan.^[308] Azerbaijani president Ilham Aliyev said that "Iran committed terror acts against Azerbaijan".^[309] Turkey likewise condemned the strikes in Azerbaijan.^[310]

Other developments

- UK defence minister John Healey visits Cyprus. No missiles were sent toward the country, but alarms in British bases rang twice, causing widespread panic and self evacuations in the local population.^[311]
- Italy, the Netherlands and Spain confirm that they will be sending warships to defend Cyprus,^[312] including the Cristóbal Colón frigate.^[313] If requested, Ireland stated they would be willing to protect Cyprus and join the European defense coalition that had mobilized around the island.^[314]
- Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky states that Ukraine has received an American request for assistance with Iranian Shahed drones. President Trump stated that he will accept Ukrainian assistance.^{[315][316]}

6 March

- According to reports US and Israel executed heavy airstrikes on Tehran, Kermanshah as well as Salmas, Maku and Saqqez in western Iran.^[317]
- Late on Friday, drones struck Iraqi airports and oil facilities; in Basra, a compound housing foreign oil-company workers, including Halliburton and KBR facilities, was hit and caught fire.^[318]
- President Masoud Pezeshkian issued an apology on state television for waves of Iranian attacks against neighbouring countries, stating that Iran had not attacked "friendly and neighboring countries".^[319]
- The Sri Lanka Navy announced that the Sri Lanka Navy would take charge of the Iranian tanker IRIS Bushehr and its crew of 208, with the crew to be brought ashore and the vessel moved to the Trincomalee area.^[320] This is the first instance of a warship being interned in a neutral country since World War II.
- US and Israeli airstrikes hit an IRGC intelligence site in Lorestan.^[321]
- Three Ghanaian peacekeepers enrolled in UNIFIL were hit by a missile and wounded in Southern Lebanon.^[322]
- In Azerbaijan, an alleged Iranian-linked terrorist plot against the Baku–Tbilisi–Ceyhan oil pipeline, the Israeli embassy and synagogues in Baku is prevented by local law enforcement,^{[323][324]} with the trial of said alleged terrorists starting on the same day, during which they were identified as being part of a cell of the Islamic State known as "Vilayati-Khorasan" and the IRGC.^{[325][326]}



Worshippers gather at the Imam Khomeini Mosalla for the first Friday prayer after the 2026 airstrikes on Tehran.

- US and Israeli airstrikes hit an IRGC intelligence site in Lorestan.^[327]

Iranian and Hezbollah strikes and renewed Gulf offensive

- Iran opened a new and wider campaign on Gulf states^[328] with attacks on Saudi Arabia (3 missiles had been intercepted at Prince Sultan Air Base), Kuwait (with drones and missiles), Qatar (where 13 missiles were intercepted), Bahrain (where a hotel and two residential buildings were targeted), and the UAE.^{[328][329]}
- The compounds and oil refineries structures of the US-based firm Halliburton located in Basra were hit by Iranian strikes late on Friday.^[330]

Timestamped events (UTC)

- ~01:00: The first airliner evacuating British nationals from the Mideast (chartered by the UK government) arrives, at London Stansted; it had departed Muscat, Oman.^[331]
- ~01:00: Four men, one an Iran national and three dual British-Iranian nationals, are arrested in Barnet and Watford, suburbs of London, on suspicion of acting on the behalf of a foreign espionage service. They are suspected of surveilling Jewish individuals and locations.^[331] There were also six arrests in Harrow.^[331]

7 March

- US and Israeli forces executed strikes on infrastructure targets in Tehran and Isfahan.^{[332][333]} The US approved a \$151M arms sale to Israel.^[334]
- The US approves a \$151M arms sale to Israel.^[335]
- The US sends a third aircraft carrier, USS George H. W. Bush, to the Middle East.^{[336][337][338]}
- Kuwait Petroleum Corporation declared force majeure and began cutting its oil output by an unspecified amount.^[339]
- The IDF reported that it destroyed 16 Quds Force aircraft with a strike on Tehran's Mehrabad International Airport.^{[340][341]}
- The IRGC said a water desalination plant on Qeshm Island had been attacked that affected the water supply for 30 villages, blamed the US, and said they had retaliated by attacking what they said was the source of the attack,^{[342][343]} although both the US and Israel denied that they had attacked the desalination plant.^[344]
- The compounds and oil refineries structures of the US-based firm Halliburton located in Basra were hit by Iranian strikes.^[345] The IRGC attacked the Malta-flagged oil tanker *Prima* with a drone.^[346]

U.S–Israeli attacks in Iran

- US and Israeli forces executed strikes on many targets in Tehran and Isfahan.^[347] The targets of these attacks was the infrastructure of the Iranian government, according to the IDF.^[348]
- The Israeli military confirmed that several fuel storage facilities in Tehran were targeted.^[349]
- Tehran's Mehrabad International Airport is struck in the early hours, where the IDF said that it destroyed 16 Quds Force aircraft.^{[350][351]}
- The United States strikes a water desalination plant.^[352]

Iranian retaliation

- The IRGC said that it attacked the Malta-flagged oil tanker *Prima* with a drone after "ignoring repeated warnings from the IRGC Navy regarding the prohibition of traffic and the unsafe nature of the Strait of Hormuz".^[353]
- The compounds and oil refineries structures of the US-based firm Halliburton located in Basra are hit by Iranian strikes.^[330]

8 March

- Israeli rescue services said that at least three people were injured by shrapnel belonging to Iranian missiles.^[354] The IRGC said that its missiles hit "military targets" in Tel Aviv and Beersheba as well as the Muwaffaq Salti Air Base in Azraq, Jordan.^[355] An Iranian drone strike engulfed a Kuwait City tower belonging to the Public Institution for Social Security in flames.^[356]
- According to *Iran International*, Israeli American airstrikes hitting IRGC aerospace headquarters and 50 ammunition storage shelters were targeted.^[357] US officials stated that Iran was using heavy populated areas to conduct military operations.^{[358][359]}
- Kuwait reported that two of its officers were killed while performing duties.^{[356][360]}
- Israeli airstrikes hit Iran's oil facilities for the first time, killing four people.^[361]
- The United Kingdom's Ministry of Defence confirms that its forces had intercepted an Iranian drone headed towards Iraq.^[362]
- The UK Ministry of Defence declared its intention to send a Merlin helicopter to the region to help aid in detecting future aerial threats.^[362]
- US Central Command announced the death of a seventh US service member from an Iranian attack.^[363]



Sgt. Benjamin N. Pennington of the 1st Space Battalion, who died on 8 March 2026 from wounds sustained during an attack at Prince Sultan Air Base, Saudi Arabia

9 March

- Multiple explosions were reported in Bahrain, Kuwait, and Qatar early in the morning. An Iranian drone attack near Manama resulted in injuries to at least 32 Bahraini citizens, four of them "serious cases".^[364]
- UAE said that they intercepted 12 ballistic missiles and 17 drones from Iran.^[365]
- Saudi Arabia said that its forces had destroyed four drones targeting Shaybah oil field.^[366]
- Iran continued firing missiles on Israel with reports saying that at least one was carrying a cluster of bomb warhead.^[367] A cluster bomb attack killed two workers at a construction site in Yehud and injured a third in Or Yehuda.^[368]
- BAPCO declared force majeure on oil exports after an Iranian attack hit its only refinery.^[369]



Blood donation in Isfahan, March 2026

10 March

- According to sources, Iran targeted US military sites in Harir Air Base in the Kurdistan region of Iraq.^[370]
- Israel said that it struck a weapons research site in Tehran.^[371]
- Syrian media reported how the Israelis intercepted Iranian drones in the towns of Jalin and the Israeli-occupied town of Quneitra.^[372]
- The Saudi Civil Defense said that a drone fell in the city of Al-Zulfi, causing material damage but no injuries.^[373]
- The UNHCR reported that about 700 thousand people were displaced in Lebanon by Israeli bombing and mass evacuations.^[374]
- ADNOC shut down its Ruwais refinery due to fire from a drone strike.^[375]
- According to US sources they struck multiple Iranian minelaying ships.^[376]

11 March

- Bulk carrier Mayuree Naree (IMO 9323649) is hit by two missiles shortly after passing the Strait of Hormuz. The vessel caught fire and most of the crew abandoned ship.^[377] Marshall Islands-flagged bulk carrier Star Gwyneth (IMO 9301031) and Japan-flagged container vessel One Majesty (IMO 9424912) were also reported to have been damaged by unknown projectiles in the vicinity of the Strait.^[378]
- The spokesperson of the Iraqi armed forces, Lieutenant General Saad Maan, said that two foreign vessels were hit near the port of Al-Faw, one person was killed while 35 people were rescued.^[379]
- Two drones fell near Dubai International Airport, wounding four people.^[380] Drones also struck fuel tanks at the Port of Salalah, Oman, leading the port to suspend its operations.^[381]
- Israeli drone strikes hit checkpoints in Tehran, killing at least ten people, including several Basij members.^[382]
- A cargo ship caught fire in the straits when it was hit by a projectile, according to the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations agency.^[383]
- Iran fired dozens of missiles at targets throughout the Gulf region as the US and Israel launched attacks on targets in Iran.^[384] IRGC announced attacks against Camp Buehring in Kuwait in a two-pronged missile attack, as well as drone and missile attacks on US infrastructure at the Mina Salman port in Bahrain (Naval Support Activity Bahrain), as well as the Kuwait Naval Base (Camp Patriot) and Ali Al Salem Air Base in Kuwait.^{[385][386]}

12 March

- Witnesses within Iran reported explosions and deployment of Iranian security forces in several Iranian cities.^[387]
- The Popular Mobilization Forces (PMF) militia's 18th brigade headquarters in Al-Qa'im, Iraq, was hit by a direct strike.^[388] The overnight strikes on Al-Qa'im killed 15 people, while another strike on a PMF base near Kirkuk killed five people. The strikes on the PMF were condemned by the Iraqi government.^[389]
- The IRGC reported firing 10 ballistic missiles with multiple warheads at Tel Aviv, while Israel reported 124 people injured.^[390]
- On the night of 11 to 12 of March, Iranian drones hit Bahrain International Airport on Muharraq

Island and set fuel tanks on fire.^[391]

- On the night of 11 to 12 of March, Iranian drones hit coalition military camps near Erbil and Baghdad in Iraq, wounding a number US soldiers. 2 drones were shot down by British troops.^[392]
- Two fuel tankers, Maltese-flagged Zefyros (IMO 9515917) and Marshall Islands-flagged Safesea Vishnu (IMO 9327009), are attacked in Iraqi waters and catch fire. Iraqi oil terminals suspend operations.^[393] Reporters assume that the ships have been attacked by Iranian explosive-laden boats.^[394]
- A drone attack on a Peshmerga base in the Malla Qara subdistrict of Makhmur district, injured six French soldiers.^{[395][388]} One soldier, Arnaud Frion, 7th Chasseurs Alpins was later reported killed in action.^[396]
- An American Boeing KC-135 Stratotanker crashed in western Iraq, killing all six crew.^[397] Another was damaged and made an emergency landing.^[389]
- Iranian military claimed that it targeted Israeli military bases including Palmachim Airbase, and Ovda Airbase as well as the Shin Bet headquarters.^[398]
- The first statement attributed to Iran's new Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei was read in Iranian state media by a newsreader. In the statement, Mojtaba Khamenei vowed to keep the Strait of Hormuz closed and warned countries in the region to stop hosting US bases.^[399]

13 March

- An Iranian missile strike in Zarzir, Israel damaged around 300 homes and injured around 60 people.^[400]
- Explosions were reported in Tehran during rallies for Quds Day.^{[401][402]} One person was killed by shrapnel.^[403]
- A drone attack at the Awahi Industrial Area of Sohar, Oman, killed two people and injured 11 others.^{[404][405]}

See also

- List of attacks during the 2026 Iran war
- List of aviation shootdowns and accidents during the Twelve-Day war and the 2026 Iran war

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